

Word family: ****sell / sold / selling / sale / sales / seller / salesperson / selling point / best-selling / bestseller****

****Base word:** sell**

****Past tense:** sold**

****Past participle:** sold**

****Related forms:** selling, sale, sales, seller**

****Useful family extensions:** salesperson, selling point, best-selling, bestseller, hard sell**

****Part of speech:** verb (動詞) / noun-related forms (相關名詞)**

Your sentence:

> “Another reason it worked so well was that it ****sold**** more than a product; it ****sold**** a feeling.”

Meaning in this passage

This sentence deliberately uses ****sell**** in a ****figurative marketing sense****.

The advertisement literally helped sell the product, but more importantly, it was also “selling” an ****emotional experience****: calmness, relief, escape from noise, comfort, etc.

****Meaning:**** To persuade people to want, accept, or emotionally buy into an idea, lifestyle, feeling, or image—not merely to exchange a physical product for money.

****繁體中文:**** ****不只是把商品賣給顧客，而是透過宣傳令顧客對某種感受、生活方式或概念產生嚮往，從而願意接受並購買產品****

****中文翻譯:****

> “Another reason it worked so well was that it sold more than a product; it sold a feeling.”

「它之所以如此有效，另一個原因是它所****推銷的不只是一件產品，更是一種感受****。」

Here:

****sell a feeling = 把某種情緒或生活體驗塑造成顧客想要得到的東西，藉此增加產品吸引力****

1. ****sell + product/service (產品／服務) — 出售; 把商品或服務賣給別人****

This is the basic commercial meaning.

****Meaning:**** To give someone a product, service, property, etc. in exchange for money.

Practice 1

> “The company **sells** headphones online.”

「這家公司在網上**出售耳機**。」

Practice 2

> “They **sold** the car for \$20,000.”

「他們以兩萬元**把汽車出售了**。」

sell = 把商品、服務或資產交給買方，並收取金錢作為交換

2. **sell + person + product/service** (某人 + 商品／服務) — 把某物賣給某人

Meaning: To provide a product or service to a particular buyer in exchange for payment.

Practice 3

> “The shop **sold me** a pair of wireless headphones.”

「商店**賣給我**一副無線耳機。」

Practice 4

> “They **sold the customer** a more expensive model.”

「他們**向顧客售出**了一個更昂貴的型號。」

sell someone something = 把某項商品或服務出售給某位顧客

3. **sell for + price** (售價) — 以某個價格出售

Meaning: To be sold at a particular price.

Practice 5

> “The headphones **sell for** about \$300.”

「這副耳機的**售價**約為三百元。」

Practice 6

> “Similar apartments **sell for** much more in the city centre.”

「市中心類似的單位通常**以高得多的價格出售**。」

sell for + amount = 商品或資產以某個價格成交／出售

4. **product/item sells** (商品本身) — 銷售情況如何; 賣得.....

Here, **sell** can be intransitive.

Meaning: For a product to be bought by customers, especially in a particular quantity or manner.

Practice 7

> “The new model is **selling** very well.”

「新型號**賣得非常好**, 銷量很高。」

Practice 8

> “Expensive luxury goods often **sell** more slowly.”

「昂貴的奢侈品通常**銷售速度較慢**。」

sell well/badly/quickly = 商品在市場上的實際銷售表現好／差／快

Notice:

> “The company sells headphones.”

> = 公司出售耳機。

> “The headphones sell well.”

> = 耳機銷量很好。

Different grammatical perspectives.

5. **sell + idea/message/lifestyle** (構思／理念／生活方式) — 推銷; 令別人接受或嚮往某種概念

This is one of the most important figurative meanings.

Meaning: To present an idea, belief, image, or lifestyle persuasively so that other people accept or desire it.

Practice 9

> “The campaign **sells** the idea that technology can make life calmer.”

「這項宣傳活動在**推銷**一種理念：科技可以令生活更平靜。」

Practice 10

> “Luxury brands often **sell** a lifestyle, not just a product.”

「奢侈品牌往往**推銷**的是一種令人嚮往的生活方式，而不只是一件產品。」

sell an idea/lifestyle = 透過說服和形象塑造，使別人接受、認同或嚮往某種概念

6. **sell + feeling/experience/dream** (感受／體驗／夢想) — 把某種情感體驗包裝成令人嚮往的東西

This is the exact figurative use in your original passage.

Practice 11 — Original

> “It sold more than a product; it **sold a feeling**.”

「它推銷的不只是一件產品，更**推銷**了一種令人嚮往的感受。」

Practice 12

> “The hotel advertisement **sells** a feeling of peace and escape.”

「酒店廣告在**營造並推銷**一種寧靜和逃離日常壓力的感受。」

Practice 13

> “The campaign **sold** customers the dream of a simpler life.”

「這項宣傳向顧客**推銷**一種更簡單生活的夢想和想像。」

sell a feeling/experience = 令消費者渴望某種情緒或生活體驗，並把產品與那種體驗連結起來

This belongs to the same broader figurative sense as #5, but it is especially important in **advertising and branding**.

7. **sell + proposal/plan/candidate** (提案／計劃／人選) — 說服別人接受或支持

Meaning: To persuade others that something is worth accepting, approving, or supporting.

Practice 14

> “She successfully **sold** the proposal to senior management.”

「她成功**說服**高層接受這項提案。」

Practice 15

> “You need to **sell** the idea to the rest of the team.”

「你需要**說服**團隊其他成員接受這個構思。」

sell something = 透過有說服力的介紹, 使別人願意接受、批准或支持某項建議

This is figurative: no money needs to change hands.

8. **sell yourself** (求職／專業場合) — 展示自己的優點, 說服別人認同自己的價值

This is a very common figurative expression and worth including.

Meaning: To present your abilities, experience, or qualities convincingly so that others see your value.

Practice 16

> “In an interview, you need to **sell yourself** without sounding arrogant.”

「面試時, 你需要**有說服力地**展示自己的優點和價值, 但不要顯得自大。」

Practice 17

> “She is talented, but she finds it difficult to **sell herself**.”

「她很有才華, 但不太懂得**向別人有效**展示自己的能力和價值。」

****sell yourself = 有策略地展示自己的能力和經驗或優點, 使別人認為你值得聘用或選擇****

9. ****sell = convince / be persuasive (說法／設計／故事) — 有說服力; 讓人信服****

In informal English, something can “sell” if it successfully convinces people.

Practice 18

> “The emotional story helped ****sell**** the message.”

「那個感人的故事令整個訊息****更有說服力、更容易令人接受****。」

Practice 19

> “The demonstration really ****sold**** the product.”

「那次示範真正****證明了產品的價值, 令顧客更想購買****。」

****sell = 透過證據、表現或敘述令某項主張／產品變得可信而有吸引力****

10. ****sale = act of selling something (出售行為／交易) — 出售; 銷售****

Here, ****sale**** is a noun.

Practice 20

> “The ****sale**** of the property was completed last week.”

「那項物業的****出售交易****上星期完成。」

Practice 21

> “The law restricts the ****sale**** of certain products.”

「法律限制某些產品的****銷售****。」

****sale = 把商品、資產或服務出售給買方的行為／交易****

11. **sale = period/event with reduced prices (減價活動) — 減價; 特價促銷**

This is a very common separate noun meaning.

Practice 22

> “The headphones are in the summer **sale**.”

「這副耳機正在夏季**減價促銷**中。」

Practice 23

> “I bought the jacket during a **sale**.”

「我在**減價活動期間**買了這件外套。」

****a sale = 商店在一段時間內以較低價格出售商品的促銷活動****

Important:

* **a sale of property** → 出售交易

* **a summer sale** → 減價促銷

12. **for sale = available to be bought — 待售; 正在出售**

Practice 24

> “The house is **for sale**.”

「這間房子正在**放售／待售**。」

Practice 25

> “Is this item **for sale**?”

「這件物品是**可以購買／正在出售的**嗎？」

****for sale = 某物目前可供別人購買****

Do not confuse:

> **for sale** = 正在出售

> **on sale** = 視地區及語境可指「出售中」, 但在美式英語中經常表示「減價中」

13. **sales** = business activity of selling products/services (銷售工作／業務) — 銷售; 銷售業務

Practice 26

> “She works in **sales**.”

「她從事**銷售工作**。」

Practice 27

> “The company hired a new **sales** manager.”

「公司聘請了一位新的**銷售經理**。」

sales = 與尋找顧客、推廣產品和完成交易有關的商業工作領域

14. **sales** = quantity/value sold (銷量／銷售額) — 銷售量; 銷售額

Practice 28

> “Online **sales** increased by twenty percent.”

「網上**銷售額／銷量**增加了百分之二十。」

Practice 29

> “The advertisement caused a sharp rise in **sales**.”

「這則廣告令**銷售量大幅上升**。」

sales = 在某段時間內實際售出的商品數量或產生的銷售金額

Context determines whether Chinese should be:

* **銷量**

* **銷售額**

15. ****seller** = person/company that sells something (賣方) — 賣家; 銷售者******

Practice 30

> “The ****seller**** agreed to lower the price.”

「****賣方／賣家****同意降低價格。」

Practice 31

> “Contact the ****seller**** if the item arrives damaged.”

「如果貨品到達時已損壞, 請聯絡****賣家****。」

****seller** = 提供商品或資產並收取金錢的一方******

16. ****seller** = product that sells in a particular way (商品) — 銷路.....的商品******

This often appears with adjectives.

Practice 32

> “The headphones became a strong ****seller****.”

「這副耳機成為一款****銷量很好的商品****。」

Practice 33

> “That model was a poor ****seller****.”

「那個型號是一款****銷量很差的商品****。」

****a good/poor seller** = 銷量表現好／差的**商品****

17. ****bestseller** = product/book that sells extremely well — 暢銷品; 暢銷書******

Practice 34

> “The novel became an international **bestseller**.”

「這本小說成為國際**暢銷書**。」

Practice 35

> “The headphones quickly became a **bestseller**.”

「這副耳機很快成為**暢銷產品**。」

bestseller = 在同類商品中銷量特別高、非常暢銷的產品

18. **best-selling** = having very high sales — 暢銷的

Practice 36

> “It is one of the company’s **best-selling** products.”

「它是公司其中一款**最暢銷的產品**。」

Practice 37

> “She is a **best-selling** author.”

「她是一位作品銷量很高的**暢銷作家**。」

best-selling = 銷量在同類產品／作品中屬於最高的一批

19. **salesperson** = person whose job is selling — 銷售人員；售貨員

Practice 38

> “The **salesperson** explained the differences between the two models.”

「**銷售人員**解釋了兩個型號之間的分別。」

Practice 39

> “A good **salesperson** listens carefully to customers.”

「優秀的**銷售人員**會仔細聆聽顧客需要。」

****salesperson = 以介紹、推廣及出售產品／服務為工作的職員****

Related words:

* ****sales representative / sales rep** = 銷售代表**

* ****sales assistant** = 售貨員／銷售助理**

****salesperson** is gender-neutral.**

20. ****selling point = feature that makes something attractive to buyers — 賣點; 吸引顧客的主要優勢****

This is especially relevant to your advertising lesson.

Practice 40

> “Noise cancellation is the headphones’ main ****selling point****.”

「降噪功能是這副耳機最主要的****賣點／吸引顧客購買的優勢****。」

Practice 41

> “The apartment’s location is a major ****selling point****.”

「這個單位的地點是一個主要****賣點****。」

****selling point = 某項產品、服務或方案最能吸引別人選擇它的特點／優勢****

21. ****hard sell = aggressive, high-pressure attempt to persuade someone to buy — 強硬推銷; 高壓銷售手法****

This is an excellent family extension for your passage because earlier you had:

> “It was not flashy, aggressive...”

Practice 42

> “Customers often dislike the ****hard sell****.”

「顧客通常不喜歡****咄咄逼人、給人壓力的強硬推銷方式****。」

Practice 43

> “The advertisement avoided the **hard sell** and focused on everyday life.”

「這則廣告避免使用**高壓式推銷手法**，而是集中呈現日常生活。」

hard sell = 透過強烈催促、壓力或非常直接的說服來逼使顧客購買的銷售方式

Important distinction: **sell vs sale**

A classic learner confusion.

sell

= verb

> “They **sell** headphones.”

「他們**出售**耳機。」

sale

= noun

> “The **sale** of headphones increased.”

「耳機的**銷售**增加了。」

So:

* sell = 賣

* sale = 銷售／出售／減價活動

Important distinction: **sale vs sales**

sale

can refer to:

- * one selling transaction
- * the act of selling
- * a discount event

sales

often means:

- * the selling function of a business
- * quantities/revenue sold

> “She works in **sales**.”

= 她從事銷售工作。

> “**Sales** increased.”

= 銷量／銷售額增加。

Important distinction: **sell vs market**

sell

focuses on convincing someone to buy and completing transactions.

market

focuses more broadly on promoting, positioning, communicating, and creating demand.

A company can **market** a product successfully even before a specific item has been **sold**.

Important distinction: **sell vs advertise**

advertise

= publicly promote something

sell

= get people to buy or accept it

> “The company advertised the headphones.”

「公司為耳機做廣告。」

> “The campaign sold the idea of peace and quiet.”

「這項宣傳成功推銷了寧靜舒適這個概念。」

An advertisement can **advertise a product** while also **selling a feeling**.

Important distinction: **sell a product vs **sell a feeling****

This distinction is central to your passage.

**sell a product**

= persuade customers to purchase the physical item/service

**sell a feeling**

= persuade customers that purchasing the product will give them a desired emotional experience

In this advertisement:

product: noise-cancelling headphones

feeling: calmness, relief, personal space, escape from stressful noise

The advertisement therefore connects:

> **buying the headphones → obtaining that feeling**

That is what the writer means by:

> “It sold more than a product; it sold a feeling.”

Important distinction: **seller vs **salesperson****

**seller**

= whoever owns/provides the thing being sold

This can be:

- * a person
- * a company
- * an online merchant

salesperson

= someone whose **job** is to sell products/services

If you sell your old phone online once, you are the **seller**, but you are not necessarily a **salesperson**.

Family-extension note

Following our Golden Manual, these are especially useful:

- * **sell a product** = 出售／推銷產品
- * **sell an idea** = 推銷／說服別人接受構思
- * **sell a lifestyle** = 推銷令人嚮往的生活方式
- * **sell a feeling** = 把情緒體驗塑造成顧客渴望得到的東西
- * **sell yourself** = 展示並推銷自己的能力／價值
- * **sale** = 銷售；出售；減價活動
- * **for sale** = 待售
- * **sales** = 銷售工作；銷量／銷售額
- * **seller** = 賣方／賣家
- * **salesperson** = 銷售人員
- * **selling point** = 賣點
- * **bestseller** = 暢銷品
- * **best-selling** = 暢銷的
- * **hard sell** = 強硬、高壓式推銷

Under our no-phrasal-verbs-by-default rule, I'm deliberately **not expanding into the many phrasal constructions built from *sell*** unless one becomes relevant to the passage.

Master comparison

Form / sense	MCQ-ready Traditional Chinese meaning
-----	-----

sell a product/service	把商品、服務或資產提供給買方，並收取金錢作交換	
sell someone something	把某項商品或服務出售給特定顧客	
sell for + price	商品或資產以某個特定價格成交／出售	
product sells well/badly	商品在市場上的實際銷量／銷售表現好或差	
sell an idea/lifestyle	透過說服和形象塑造，使別人接受或嚮往某種概念	
sell a feeling/experience	令消費者渴望某種情緒／生活體驗，並把產品與該體驗連結	
sell a proposal/plan	透過有說服力的介紹，使別人接受、批准或支持某項建議	
sell yourself	有策略地展示自己的能力和經驗及價值，使別人願意選擇你	
sell — persuade	透過證據、表現或敘述使某項產品／主張變得可信而有吸引力	
sale — transaction	把商品、資產或服務出售給買方的行為／交易	
sale — discount event	在一段時間內以較低價格出售商品的減價促銷活動	
for sale	某物目前可供購買／正在出售	
sales — business function	尋找顧客、推廣產品及完成交易的商業工作領域	
sales — amount/value	某段時間內實際售出的數量或產生的銷售金額	
seller — person/company	提供商品或資產並收取金錢的一方	
seller — product	銷售表現屬於某種水平的商品	
salesperson	以介紹、推廣和出售產品／服務為工作的職員	
selling point	最能吸引顧客選擇某項產品或方案的特點／優勢	
bestseller	在同類商品／作品中銷量特別高的暢銷品	
best-selling	銷量在同類產品／作品中屬於最高的一批	
hard sell	透過強烈催促或壓力逼使顧客購買的高壓銷售方式	

For your original sentence

> “Another reason it worked so well was that it ****sold more than a product; it sold a feeling****.”

The exact meaning is:

****sell = 透過廣告令消費者不只是想購買實體商品，而是認同並渴望商品所象徵的情感或生活體驗****

So:

> ****it sold a feeling****

= ****它把「平靜、舒適、遠離噪音和壓力」這種感受本身也包裝成值得追求的東西，令顧客覺得購買耳機就能獲得那種體驗。****